

Training manual

Every system we run, and how each person learns theirs. The rule throughout: nobody is trained because they attended — they're trained because they can do the job on a live file with someone watching. Most modules take under an hour, and every one runs on real project material, never invented examples.

HOW TRAINING WORKS HERE

Each module below says who it's for, how long it takes, and exactly what someone must be able to do before they're signed off. The trainer is whoever already holds the sign-off — knowledge passes person to person, which is how it sticks on site. New starters take their role's modules in their first fortnight; everyone repeats their core module once a year, using that year's live files. Keep the record simple: a one-line entry per person per module in the training register on SharePoint — name, module, date, who signed it.

WHO TAKES WHAT

MODULE	DIRECTORS	QS / ESTIMATING	PROJECT DIRECTOR	SITE MANAGER	SUPERVISORS	ACCOUNTS	OFFICE / BD
1 · The thread	●	●	●	●	●	●	●
2 · Brand & documents	●						●
3 · EDM Measure		●	●				
4 · EDM Evidence			●	●	●		
5 · EDM Daybook				●	●		
6 · EDM Progress			●	●			
7 · EDM Cashflow	●	●				●	
8 · EDM Board	●		●				
9 · Handover pack		●	●	●			
10 · File care	●	●	●	●	●	●	●
11 · Winning work	●	●					●
12 · EDM OS	●	●	●			●	●

Module 1 — The thread

Everyone · 30 minutes · first day · trainer: any director

The one idea the whole system hangs on: a wall gets its number at tender and keeps it forever. W07 on the takeoff is W07 on the cabin plan, in the inspection record, the daybook, the weekly report and the handover file. The same goes for project names — agreed once, spelled the same everywhere, because the group board links files by name.

- Walk one wall through its whole life on a real project: takeoff to bill to inspection to handover.
- Show where the thread breaks if a name changes or a ref gets retyped wrongly.

Signed off when you can:

- Explain, in your own words, why the wall number never changes.
- Find one wall in three different files inside two minutes.

Module 2 — Brand & documents

Directors, office & BD · 45 minutes · trainer: whoever owns the brand pack

What leaves the building carries the name, so everyone who sends things out learns the same few rules: white background, one green, the cube keeps its grey panel, Montserrat everywhere, and the wording is "Fit-Out & Drywall Specialists" — nothing older. Where to find the letterhead, cards, signatures, capability statement and brochure, and which folder items are internal-only.

Signed off when you can:

- Produce the right document for a new enquiry without asking.
- Install your own email signature and spot an off-brand file at a glance.

Module 3 — EDM Measure

QS & estimating, PDs · 90 minutes · trainer: senior QS

The takeoff tool. Load a drawing, calibrate against a known dimension, prove the scale with a second one, then trace — every run lands priced in the bill. Covers the wall-type library, editing rates, door deductions, the revision overlay for measuring change, CSV export into the pricing workbook, and printing the wall reference plan for the cabin.

- Practise on a drawing from a live or recent tender, not a sample.
- Deliberately miscalibrate once, watch every number go wrong, then fix it — the lesson that makes the check-dimension habit permanent.

Signed off when you can:

- Take off a floor and land within two per cent of a senior QS doing the same sheet.
- Show, for any figure in the bill, the exact line on the drawing it came from.
- Overlay a revision and price the difference.

Module 4 — EDM Evidence

Supervisors, site managers, PDs · 60 minutes · on site, on a phone · trainer: PD

The inspection record. Import the wall register from the takeoff, then work each wall through its eight stages — pass, fail or not applicable, initials, note. The two rules that are never bent: no wall closes without its photo, and no fire-stopping passes without its photo. Failed checks stay on the record next to the passes; that's what makes a pass mean something.

Signed off when you can:

- Take one real wall from framing to decoration in the record, photos and all, standing in front of it.
- Explain to a new starter why the tool refuses a pass without the photo.

Module 5 — EDM Daybook

Site managers, supervisors · 45 minutes · trainer: site manager

One page a day: labour by trade, weather, deliveries and their condition, snags, and the section that earns its keep — every verbal instruction, logged the moment it's given, with who said it, what they said, and a photo. The habit to drill: the agent speaks, the phone comes out, ten seconds, done. That entry is the difference between a paid variation and free work.

Signed off when you can:

- Complete a full day's record in under ten minutes at day's end.
- Role-play a verbal instruction and have it logged, timed and photographed before the conversation ends.

Module 6 — EDM Progress

PDs, site managers · 60 minutes · trainer: PD or COO

The programme board. Import the takeoff, set one start date per stage per zone — that's the whole plan — then import the evidence file and watch actuals fill themselves in from what's been signed. Covers the lookahead, the delay log (dated the day it happens, closed out when it clears), and the one-minute Friday report. The discipline: the delay log is written daily, not remembered monthly.

Signed off when you can:

- Set up a project's plan from scratch in under twenty minutes.
- Produce the weekly report and defend every number on it from the underlying records.
- Show a month-old delay entry and explain what it will be worth in an extension-of-time conversation.

Module 7 — EDM Cashflow

Accounts, CFO, QS, directors · 60 minutes · trainer: CFO

Applied is not certified, and certified is not paid. One row per monthly application; when the certificate lands, the shortfall calculates itself and demands its reason — an unexplained shortfall becomes a discount. Covers due dates from payment terms, the aged unpaid view as the client early-warning, the retention ledger with both release dates, and the monthly cash report. The habit: certificates entered the day they arrive, not at month-end.

Signed off when you can:

- Set up a project and take three applications through to paid, correctly.
- Say what the aged-overdue column is really telling you about a client.
- Name both retention release dates for every live job without opening the file.

Module 8 — EDM Board

COO, directors, PDs · 30 minutes · trainer: COO

The Monday screen. Load the week's team files in one go; the board sorts out which is which, matches by project name, and rolls the group up — completion, lateness, labour, money, and the attention list. Then the weekly operations summary prints and the Monday meeting starts with facts. The dependency to respect: it's only as fresh as the files the teams saved, which is Module 10's whole point.

Signed off when you can:

- Build the Monday picture from the week's files in under five minutes.
- Trace any red item back to the working file it came from.

Module 9 — The handover pack

PDs, QS, site managers · 30 minutes · trainer: PD

How the job ends: printing the quality and fire-stopping pack from the evidence records, checking every wall is signed through, pairing it with the Handover Standard one-pager, and issuing it as one document. The point to land: this pack is a selling document for the next job as much as a closing document for this one.

Signed off when you can:

- Produce a complete pack and spot an unfinished wall record before the client does.

Module 10 — File care

Everyone · 20 minutes · trainer: technical lead or PD

The whole backup strategy is one habit: save to the project's SharePoint folder before you leave site. Covers the folder structure, the naming rule from Module 1, and why a dropped phone costs nothing if the day was saved — and a fortnight's evidence if it wasn't.

Signed off when you can:

- Save and re-open your tool's file from the right project folder, on your own device.

Module 11 — Winning work

Directors, BD, QS · 45 minutes · trainer: CEO or COO

The commercial kit and how it's used: the capability statement and deck, the outreach messages (first touch, one follow-up, then leave it a month), the tender cover note, the after-decision notes win or lose, the PQQ pack kept current so prequalification is copy-and-paste, and the content bank's rhythm on LinkedIn. The register matters: everything sends in our plain voice, nothing gets dressed up.

Signed off when you can:

- Take a cold contact through first touch to tender submission using the kit, adapting the words without losing the voice.

Module 12 — EDM OS

Office, accounts, QS, directors · half a day, during the pilot · trainer: the pilot owner

Trained on the pilot project, not before — real pipeline, real people, real timesheets, which is the only training data that counts. Covers the CRM from enquiry to award, document control, the labour core (register, allocations, attendance, timesheets against the rate card), and the integrations. Written properly once the thirty-day pilot verdict is in, by the person who lived in it.

Signed off when you can:

- Run your part of the pilot project for a full week without leaning on the owner.

NEW STARTERS AND REFRESHERS

A new starter takes Module 1 and Module 10 on day one, then their role's modules within a fortnight, each signed by the current holder. Everyone repeats their core module annually on that year's live files — twenty minutes, and it catches the drift before the drift catches a job. When a tool changes, whoever

owns it walks the change through at the next weekly meeting; five minutes there beats a surprise on site.

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